

**Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole Meeting
March 9, 2022
Meeting via zoom
4:00 to 6:00 PM**

**4:07 PM: Roll Call: Sharon Hays, Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Present
Mea Mustone: Will be joining shortly.**

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: I believe we left off on page 11-12 of the booklet.

Kathy Kreatz: I need to bring something up about number 51.

Melanie McLaughlin: Can someone please put the document up with a screen share?

Kathy Kreatz: 51: I think 6:30 to 9:30 is more reasonable. Motion to amend time change from 11 pm to 9:30 PM. At 9:30 the chair will motion to extend or recess the meeting. 6:30 to 11:30 PM is too late for everyone who has to go to work the next day.

Melanie: I second it. This has been a conversation I have had with the administrators. 11:00 meetings have been difficult.

Mea Mustone joined the meeting at 4:12.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: 9:30 end time is reasonable. 11:00 is a bit too much. Too long a day for us to function coherently. I am in support of a 9:30 check in.

Sharon Hays: I certainly don't want to make anyone's days longer. At some point, if we keep backloading each week's old agenda items, we are not going to get through the material. I thought that the point of the rule was to be that 11 would be as late as we could go.

Paul Ruseau: Member Hays' interpretation is correct. This is drawing a line in the sand and having the meeting end at 11pm. What is the body going to do when items don't get finished or people show up to speak and don't have the opportunity to speak on the item. We will certainly have to go to weekly meetings if we go to 9:30 end times.

Jenny Graham: We have been elected to do a job and there is a general expectation that we will do the job whatever it takes. I am not in favor of very late meetings and it is why I pushed to not start meetings until 6:30 so the public could weigh in on new business items after 7. I am a proponent of starting the meeting at 6 with an end time of 10:30.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: When the meetings need to run long or there is a heavy agenda, those meetings will happen. Some of our meetings do end up running long. The 11:00 end time was shocking to colleagues. MASC says efficient meetings should be up to two hours long. We have been trying to keep our items concise. It makes for a long day for the school side staff if a meeting goes to 11PM. I am hoping we won't have many meetings go to 11:00 PM.

Kathy Kreatz: I am going to keep my motion on the floor. I am exhausted by 9:30. A motion can be made to extend the meeting until a later time if a pressing matter is being discussed. I am trying to keep it equitable for everybody. Everyone needs to get up early the next day.

Breanna: Maybe we can compromise and say until 10PM.

Kathy Kreatz: I don't want to withdraw the motion but listening to Ms. Graham, we could start the meeting at 6 and end at 9:30 and then make motions to extend if need be.

Melanie McLaughlin: Second.

Sharon Hays: We had a lengthy discussion about 6/6:30 start time last time. 6:00 is more difficult for members of the public to watch. I would vote to stay with 6:30.

Jenny Graham: I am sensitive to these competing priorities being difficult but we have been elected to do a hard job. We don't get to the new items until later. I think 6 to 10 would be a great window that way we don't have to vote to extend meetings very often. We would need $\frac{2}{3}$ vote to continue and sometimes there might be a room full of people waiting to speak.

Melanie McLaughlin: I appreciate the willingness to negotiate. I don't think for me it is about working less - it is about working more efficiently. I think some of the rules being proposed might lead to more efficient meetings. I am sensitive to the staff working longer hours after a long day. If folks are willing to sever the motion, we could consider it. A four hour meeting is quite long - how productive is that after two hours.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Motion on floor 6 to 10 with ability to extend.

Kathy Kreatz: my motion which is on the floor is 6 to 9:30 with the option to extend.

Sharon Hays: I would like to sever.

Melanie: Second motion to sever at 4:33.

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/SH/MM/Melanie McLaughlin/PR/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 Motion is severed.

Motion on floor to start meeting at 6:00PM.

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz: yes Sharon Hays: no Mea Mustone: yes Melanie McLaughlin: yes Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: No

5/2 motion to start at 6:00PM approved

Motion to end at 9:30:

Jenny Graham: No

Paul Ruseau: No

Rest: yes

5/2: meeting shall end at 9:30 unless extended.

Jenny Graham: I believe at the last meeting we put 67 off the table to discuss.

Melanie: Second

7/0 67 has been taken off the table

Jenny Graham: Motion to approve 67 as written.

“A motion to rescind is used to reconsider a decision adopted by the SC at any time other than the current meeting (when a motion to reconsider is appropriate).”

Melanie: This is very complicated.

Paul Ruseau: This is from Roberts Rules of Order. I thought it would be good to have the rescind and reconsider back to back to clarify. There is nothing in this that is not from Roberts Rules of Order. I included it just to make it clear for the members.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would make a friendly suggestion to hyper link to Roberts Rules.

Paul Ruseau: I was going to make a motion to do just this and link Roberts Rules where appropriate.

Melanie McLaughlin: I make a motion to add a reference and a hyperlink to Roberts Rules when relevant.

Jenny Graham: Second

Paul Ruseau: Hyperlinks will lead to a website.

Melanie McLaughlin: I am wanting to have a link from this document to a roberts rules document.

Jenny Graham: This specific detail is not available for the website because they want you to buy the book.

Paul Ruseau: The website has a FAQ but doesn't list the actual rules of order. You cannot refer to the actual rules on the web because they are copyrighted.

Melanie McLaughlin: To that end, it doesn't have to be specific to the actual rule, it can lead to the website so they know what Roberts Rules of Order is. Otherwise it has no anchor or meaning.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would ask that there are parenthetical citations that are Roberts Rules specific and at the end of the document which will be posted on line, there will be a reference page linked to the Roberts Rules of Order website.

Jenny Graham: Second

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatez/sh/mm/mm/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes as amended

Paul Ruseau: Jenny graham had motioned to accept the rule (67) as written.

Melanie: second

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatez/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes as amended

Kathy Kreatez; I have concerns about #77.

"All requests passed by the Medford City Council that pertain to the Medford Public Schools will be sent to the School Committee to be part of the next agenda in accordance with School Committee procedure and timing as found in Addendum 1 - Add Item to Agenda."

I don't believe this is something that is currently being done. I feel it is restrictive that the Supt. is not to respond to the City Council without going through the SC.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: I tend to agree. It restricts the Supt's ability to do her job.

Paul Ruseau: We have no process if the city council wants to ask the SC a question. As for the part regarding to the Supt. being called to the City Council, the superintendent has no relationship to the City Council. I don't think it is fair to the superintendent to be responsible to attend if the city council says so. They should need to ask permission. The superintendent works for the SC and should not have to report to two public bodies.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: In my short time in this role, I have never had a situation where the Medford City Council was calling me on a weekly basis. My main contact is at the end of the budget season. The requests have been very reasonable, basic inquiries. A constituent may have asked them a question and they just reach out to me. I don't feel that the item (77) is necessary. It is so rare that putting this insinuates that there is a problem. I deal with the clerk's office to post meetings and he is always responsive to posting. I have never had something asked of me by a city council that would be a cause for alarm. I would definitely notify the SC immediately. Usually, the requests from the City Council will come from the Mayor's office. Fewer than ten in the last four years.

Jenny Graham: My understanding of this motion is not that the council would have to do this with a harmless question but if they take a vote on something regarding schools, I do believe that should come before the School Committee. We are headed towards some very interesting discussions as we talk about ARPA funds, the high school project and other difficult topics. I am a proponent of a process that establishes good habits. If this comes to blows about the high school, it won't be the time to establish a process. We get a lot of pushback from the admin when we ask for things when there is not enough capacity. Some of these things from the Council will take the time of our administrative staff. We need to be able to decide the prioritization of these items and a structure as a body.

Paul Ruseau: This is not about council members asking the superintendent a question. That is fine - they are members of the public asking the superintendent a question. This is regarding items being voted on. I expect that the council will have questions regarding big expensive items coming in the future. It has not been a problem in the past but it may be one with ARPA and the high school conversation. There have been cases when they have asked the school committee for something and we don't know what to do with it.

Melanie McLaughlin: I appreciate the policy in its effort to expand conversation between City Council and School Committee. The first half makes sense to me. The second half makes more sense now with the explanation of my colleagues. Referring to the request for a majority vote is fine. The wording "not authorized" and "without" is a bit challenging. I would make a friendly amendment to remove the wording.

Kathy Kreatz: I am still having difficulty with the wording of the rule. For the first part, all motions passed.....will be sent by the city council to the sc to add to agenda. The second part: I don't understand why we have to include the majority vote of the school committee. She should be able to answer the councilor without putting it on the agenda. Add requests "within reason." The way it is written right now is too restrictive. It does insinuate we are having problems with City Council and we are not.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: The way it works is the City Council votes on it, and it gets sent to the superintendent from my office (cc'ing the School Committee).

Jenny Graham: I want to reframe the reason we are discussing rules. It is no implication of this moment. It is our collective goal to operate efficiently and prevent problems in the future. The document is not connected to any controversial issue. I have no idea of what your amendment is.

Kathy Kreatz: Let me reflect on what the mayor just mentioned. All motions passed by City Council that reference MPS will be sent to by the CC President to the SC chair who will determine with the Superintendent if it should be put on the agenda.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: the supt knows when to loop the sc in. It has been working pretty well. Our meetings will get even longer if we add everything to the agenda.

Kathy Kreatz: Motion to change number 77: All motions passed by City Council that reference MPS will be sent to by the CC President to the SC chair to be reviewed with the superintendent to determine whether it should be a SC agenda item. I would like to record 77 as it is working now.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: City council to city clerk to my office to the superintendent's office.

Kathy Kreatz: If it is not working, we can bring it up at a future meeting.

Paul Ruseau: Nobody here knew what the process was except the Mayor and the superintendent. It is fascinating that we are putting trust in the process that nobody knew but the neighborhood. I don't think we can specify that the City Council president will do something. We don't have that authority nor can we tell the city clerk what to do. We did have a motion to change the language to strength based. I second that.

Roll: 6 yes

Kathy Kreatz: no. I would like to strike the whole sentence.

Kathy Kreatz: Motion to strike the entire last sentence.

No second;

Jenny Graham: it might make sense to change the language to the council if the request can be answered with publicly available information, the superintendent will do so. If it requires more time, effort or money, it should go on the agenda.
It is not to say we are going to gate keep public information.

Kathy Kreatz: I still have the motion on the floor for the beginning part of the rule. Did it have a second from anybody on the wording.

Motion:

All requests passed by Medford City Council that pertain to MPS will be sent to the SC chair and will be reviewed by the Supt. as to whether it can be answered or added to the agenda.

Jenny Graham: Perhaps we can say, "answered with publicly available information " and that would put an end cap on this?

Motion as amended by Jenny Graham:

Roll: YES: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes as amended

Rule Number 88

Kathy Kreatz: The secretary and the Mayor will look out for hands raised.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Actually Dr. Cushing has been doing that for me.

Kathy Kreatz: The secretary and superintendent or another administrator will identify if there is a hand raised to speak on any item on the agenda.

Seconded by Melanie McLaughlin

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes

Kathy Kreatz: 82 is redundant with 83. I believe we should strike 83.

Melanie McLaughlin: Second

Paul Ruseau: I am a bit concerned we are not specifying who is responsible. We could identify the person at the beginning of the meeting. It happens when we are in person but the public are participating by zoom. I don't want to have it look like we are not letting the public speak.

Melanie McLaughlin: can we just merge 82 and 83?

Kathy Kreatz: second. I remove my motion.

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes

Kathy Kreatz: 84 exception to the rule.....with the exception of illness, bereavement or emergency. What are the superintendent's thoughts?

Paul Ruseau: Second

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes

Melanie McLaughlin: Thanks for the hard work on the rules document and the collaboration exemplified by member Kreatz shows how we can all work together as a team. I have a question as to how this booklet will be married with the SC Policies? I don't want them to be redundant.

Paul Ruseau: The rules are much better now that we have collaborated on them. I have a motion that would cover the concerns:

I motion for the secretary to go through each line to reference the SC policies when pertinent.

Melanie McLaughlin: I wish that the policies could also be in a google doc. Friendly amendment that the policy document is updated to a similar format as the rules document so it can be user friendly to the public and candidates.

Kathy Kreatz: I have a question about number 90.

Paul Ruseau: I am not ok with that amendment. The policy document is hundreds of pages.

Melanie McLaughlin: Point of information: would it be acceptable if I offered to do the reformatting similarly to the rules document?

Paul Ruseau : You can send that to the next school committee meeting. That is additional work not related to the rules document.

BLK: Is there a second?

Melanie McLaughlin: second

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 motion passes

Kathy Kreatz: Rule number 90. This is a new rule that is put forth. It would be handled by the Superintendent's office.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: Based on meetings from the end of the year, we do have an internal tracking system with most of these fields. Ms. Weiss has been managing this. We will add these additional fields. My request is to edit the rule from "continuing" to "containing"

Paul Ruseau: Yes, I will make a motion to correct the errors in number 90.

Melanie McLaughlin: Second

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes

Paul Ruseau: Motion to edit number rule 85. Motion to strike the "custodian of the School Committee's records and other papers."

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: I support the revision.

Paul Ruseau: I understand that it is a legally required role to identify the staff member who will be in charge of this. Maybe we can change it to the Superintendent shall appoint a custodian of records at all times.

Melanie McLaughlin: Custodian of record who is identified on the website.

Paul Ruseau: Record keeping system. The superintendent will ensure that there is an appointed custodian of record and this information will be posted on our website.

Second.

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 motion passes

Melanie McLaughlin: motion to report this document out at the next School Committee meeting.

Paul Ruseau: Second

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 paper passes

Motion to adjourn: Melanie McLaughlin
Seconded by Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz/Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn
7/0 Motion to adjourn